it makes sense that you go ahead and assign those probabilities right now. We've been forced to shift the meaning of what probability is from a simple frequentist model to a more robust epistemic picture, but how we calculate things and how we act on the basis of those calculations goes through exactly as before. That's why physicists have been able to do interesting work while avoiding these subtle questions all this time.

Intuitively, this analysis suggests that the amplitudes in a quantum wave function lead to different branches having a different "weight," which is proportional to the amplitude squared. I wouldn't want to take that mental image too literally, but it provides a concrete picture that helps us make sense of probabilities, as well as of other issues like energy conservation that we'll talk about later.

$$\text{Weight of a branch} = |\text{Amplitude of that branch}|^2$$

When there are two branches with unequal amplitudes, we say that there are only two worlds, but they don't have equal weight; the one with higher amplitude counts for more. The weights of all the branches of any particular wave function always add up to one. And when one branch splits into two, we don't simply "make more universe" by duplicating the existing one; the total weight of the two new worlds is equal to that of the single world we started with, and the overall weight stays the same. Worlds get thinner as branching proceeds.